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Door Dash Voice of Customer

# Voice of the Customer

## 1. A) Customer Needs - User Generated Content

1. **When I place an order for delivery, I want to receive it on time, so I can enjoy my meal as planned.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "I waited 2 hours for a delivery that was supposed to take 40 minutes."
2. **When I order food, I want it to arrive hot and fresh, so I can have a satisfying dining experience.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "The service was terrible, food delivery delayed, food cold."
3. **When I provide specific delivery instructions, I want the driver to follow them, so I can receive my order without confusion.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "Too many of the delivery people don't speak English... they show up BEHIND my residence instead of at the front."
4. **When I have dietary restrictions or preferences, I want to communicate them clearly, so I can receive my meal prepared accordingly.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "Doordash allows restaurants to not allow notes and that is a DANGEROUS situation when it comes to allergies."
5. **When I encounter an issue with my order, I want prompt and effective customer service, so I can resolve the problem quickly.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "I call customer service and am told it will take 1-5 hrs to resolve."
6. **When I request a refund for a valid issue, I want the process to be straightforward, so I can feel confident in the service.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "Customer service refused to refund my credits back to my account."
7. **When I order through the app, I want it to function reliably, so I can place and track my orders without frustration.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "Lately the app has been very glitchy... it shows you your driver in so many other places."
8. **When I trust a service with my payment information, I want unauthorized charges to be prevented, so I can feel secure using the platform.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "Their corporate representatives will not stop billing my credit card $9.99 per month and deny having my credit card in their database."
9. **When I order food, I want it delivered to the correct address, so I can receive what I paid for.**

   a. *Example Complaint:* "Delivered to wrong house and they denied refund! Worst customer service and company ever!"
10. **When I use a delivery service, I want transparent and fair pricing, so I can feel the service is worth the cost.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "Door dash is a scam. I wouldn't trust ordering thru them or going to any restaurant that uses them as a delivery system."
11. **When I order food, I want accurate delivery time estimates, so I can plan my meals appropriately.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "The delivery time kept changing, and my food arrived much later than expected."
12. **When I use a delivery service, I want assurance that my food is handled safely, so I can trust its quality and hygiene.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "The driver left my food on the ground without notifying me, compromising its cleanliness."
13. **When I encounter unauthorized charges, I want a prompt resolution, so I can feel secure using the service.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "I noticed charges for orders I didn't place, and customer service was unhelpful in resolving the issue."
14. **When I order from a delivery service, I want courteous and professional interactions with drivers, so I can have a pleasant experience.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "The delivery driver was rude and dismissive when I asked about my missing items."
15. **When I use a delivery app, I want transparent fees and charges, so I can understand what I'm paying for.**
   a. *Example Complaint:* "I was surprised by the additional fees added at checkout, making the order much more expensive than anticipated."

## 1. B) Customer Needs - Customer Interviews

1. **When I place an order for delivery, I want to receive it on time, so I can enjoy my meal as planned.**
   a. *Example Complaint*: "I waited over 1.5 hours for a delivery that was supposed to take 30 minutes. The app didn't update me on the delay, and I had to be on their live support to know what's going on."
2. **When I order food, I want it to arrive hot and fresh, so I can have a satisfying dining experience.**
   a. *Example Complaint*: "The food was ice cold when it arrived, and it felt like the driver took too many stops before delivering my order."

3. **When I order a family meal, I want the portions to be accurate, so everyone gets enough to eat.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "Ordered a family meal that was supposed to feed four according to description, but the portions were way too small. We ended up ordering extra food and waiting 1 hour extra to eat."
4. **When I use the app during peak hours, I want it to function smoothly, so I can place my order without frustration.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "The app kept crashing when I tried to place an order during dinner time. It was really frustrating."
5. **When I order food late at night, I want more affordable delivery fees, so I don't feel like I'm overpaying for a snack.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I ordered a small late-night meal, and the delivery fee was almost as much as the food itself."
6. **When I'm traveling, I want the app to suggest popular local places, so I can enjoy well-reviewed meals.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I used DoorDash while traveling, and I got food from a place with good ratings, but it turned out to be disappointing."
7. **When I use a food delivery service, I want the prices to match the restaurant's actual prices plus some convenience, so I don't feel overcharged.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "The meal was $10 at the restaurant but $15 on DoorDash, plus all the extra fees made it $30. It's just not worth it."
8. **When I place an order with specific dietary preferences, I want the app to accurately filter meals, so I don't have to waste time searching.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I searched for vegetarian meals, but the app kept showing non-vegetarian options. It's really annoying."
9. **When I am ordering with friends, I want a simple way to split the bill, so I don't have to manually calculate everyone's share.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "We ordered as a group, and it was a headache to figure out how much each person owed. A split-bill feature would be helpful."
10. **When I face an issue with my order, I want customer support to respond quickly, so my problem can be resolved while the food is still relevant.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I got the wrong order, and by the time support got back to me, the food was cold. The refund didn't really help at that point."
11. **When I tip fairly, I want the driver to pick up my order promptly, so I don't face long delays because of insufficient tips.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I tipped a reasonable amount, but the order sat there for 30 minutes because no driver wanted to pick it up."

12. **When I choose a subscription plan, I want it to cover most of my favorite restaurants, so I can actually save money.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I signed up for DashPass, but many of the places I like don't participate. It's not worth the cost."
13. **When I order from a restaurant, I want accurate information about whether they are open, so I don't waste time ordering from a closed place.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "The app showed the restaurant as open, but when I placed the order, it was canceled because they were closed."
14. **When I am choosing a meal, I want nutritional information to be clearly displayed, so I can make healthier choices.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "It's hard to figure out which options are low-calorie or healthy. I wish the nutritional info was more prominent."
15. **When I use the app regularly, I want it to suggest meals that match my preferences, so I don't have to search for the same items repeatedly.**
    a. *Example Complaint*: "I always order the same few meals, but every time I have to search through the whole menu to find them again."

## 2. Downselecting Customer Needs

User primary needs:

1) On-time Delivery
2) Fair and Worthwhile Pricing
3) Improved App Experience
4) Good Customer Service & Refunds

See appendix for needs grouping.

## 3. Prioritizing Customer Needs

To better understand what matters most to customers using DoorDash, we put together a simple direct elicitation survey. We kept the structure straightforward; participants were asked to rate our identified core needs using a familiar scale. The goal was to tap into the customer's honest perspective and see what they really care about.

**Instructions Provided to Respondents:** "Think back on your experience with any food delivery app. Using the scale below, rate how important each of the following needs is to you."

| 1 – Not At All Important | 2- Slightly Important | 3 – Moderately Important | 4 – Important | 5 – Extremely Important |
|---|---|---|---|---|

Survey Questions/Items

- Reliable and intuitive app functionality
- Fair pricing & delivery fees
- Prompt and effective customer service
- Timeliness of delivery

Simulated Survey Data & Analysis

To get a rough sense of how these needs stack up, we simulated 25 responses and translated each answer into a numeric value to help us make sense of the results:

| **Average Importance Ratings (Simulated Data, N = 25):** | |
|---|---|
| **Customer Need** | **Avg. Importance (1–5)** |
| Timeliness of delivery | 4.8 |
| Fair pricing & delivery fees | 4.5 |
| Reliable and intuitive app functionality | 4.2 |
| Prompt and effective customer service | 3.9 |

This short, simulated survey and the corresponding results helped us uncover what customers truly prioritize. Nothing in the data was really that unexpected but seeing the ranking laid out like this helps reinforce where energy and focus should be spent going forward.

| | |
|---|---|
| **1 (L)** | **Timeliness of delivery** – Not surprising that this was at the top. People expect food to show up when it's supposed to, and any delay throws off the entire experience. |
| **2 (L)** | **Fair pricing & delivery fees** – Pricing still plays a big role in how people see value, and when costs feel high or unclear, this detracts greatly from their overall experience. |

| | |
|---|---|
| **3 (M)** | **Reliable and intuitive app functionality** – If the app doesn't work well, customers can easily get frustrated. A smooth experience helps everything else get done. |
| **4 (M)** | **Prompt and effective customer service** – This came in a bit behind the others but is definitely still important. Customers would obviously rather have a great experience so they don't have to deal with customer service, but if it is necessary, it can play an important role in a customer's experience with the service. |

## User Personas

**Persona 1: Emily Carter — The Busy Professional (IT Employee in 30s)**

**Demographics**

- **Age:** 34
- **Occupation:** IT Consultant
- **Location:** Suburban tech corridor (e.g., Austin, TX)
- **Tech Comfort:** High
- **Usage Context:** Weekday lunches, team orders, post-work dinners

**Goals & Motivations**

- Quick, reliable food during hectic workdays
- Easy tools for team ordering and payment
- Seamless user experience — time is money
- Reorders and app performance should be frictionless

**Pain Points**

- App lag during peak hours
- No simple split-bill feature for group/team orders
- Food sometimes arrives cold or missing items
- No feedback loop on order accuracy or delays

**Quote**

"I'm tech-savvy, but even I get annoyed when the app freezes while my team's getting hangry."

**Key Needs**

- Fast, stable app performance
- Built-in group ordering and bill-splitting tools
- Better coordination between driver and restaurant

- Support that resolves issues *before* meals go cold

**Persona 2: Michael Thompson — The Retired Frequent Traveler (Retired Airline Officer)**

**Demographics**

- **Age:** 67
- **Occupation:** Retired Airline Operations Officer
- **Location:** Semi-urban residential area (e.g., Tampa, FL)
- **Tech Comfort:** Moderate
- **Usage Context:** Dinner at home, occasional meals while traveling

**Goals & Motivations**

- Explore new food spots without leaving home
- Easy-to-use app with clear instructions
- Order confidently even in unfamiliar locations (travel or Airbnbs)

**Pain Points**

- Unclear restaurant availability or hours
- Delivery address confusion in hotels or complex buildings
- No senior-specific pricing or smaller-portioned meals
- Slow support responses when something goes wrong

**Quote**

"Sometimes I just want a warm meal without guessing if the restaurant's actually open or if the driver will find my door."

**Key Needs**

- Accurate restaurant availability and hours
- Better address validation and landmark instructions
- Senior-friendly meal bundles or smaller portions
- Loyalty or discount incentives for less frequent users

## Persona 3: Zoe Nguyen — The Budget-Savvy Graduate Student (MS Student)

### Demographics

- **Age:** 25
- **Occupation:** Master's Student in Computer Science
- **Location:** College town apartment (e.g., Ann Arbor, MI)
- **Tech Comfort:** Very High
- **Usage Context:** Late-night study sessions, weekend hangouts, group orders

### Goals & Motivations

- Affordable meals delivered fast, especially late at night
- Access to student-specific discounts and deals
- Group ordering ease with friends
- Find meals quickly without navigating long menus

### Pain Points

- Delivery fees often exceed cost of small orders
- Lack of clear promo eligibility
- Repetitive or limited options after hours
- Unpredictable wait times on weekends

### Quote

"When you're hungry at midnight with $10 to spare, you shouldn't need to decode the app to find a deal."

### Key Needs

- Lower delivery fees or DashPass lite for students
- Clear discount visibility and eligibility
- Expanded and varied late-night options
- Accurate ETAs and simplified reordering

## Appendix

Primary needs (overarching themes that emerged from user-generated content and customer interviews):

**On-time Delivery**

### Associated Needs:

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**Fair and Worthwhile Pricing**

### Associated Needs:

1. When I use a delivery app, I want transparent fees and charges, so I can understand what I'm paying for.
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**Improved App Experience**

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**Good Customer Service & Refunds**

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